a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

How to Run This Year

Routines, pacing, FAQ, and the calibration of Cash's voice.

Grade 11 year theme — Leadership, Sales, and Execution.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

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Grade 11 · Teacher Guide · the magazine version of the master document, set for adults to read end-to-end.

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GRADE 11 · TEACHER GUIDE

How to Run This

Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.

11

For: high-school classroom teachers (typically business/CTE, economics, ELA, social studies, or a dedicated entrepreneurship period), homeschool parents teaching the curriculum, after-school program leads, and dual-enrollment instructors. **Companion to:** Grade 11 Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans, Student Activity Book, Cash Video Scripts, and Parent Guide.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next."

How this year is built (and why)

> "Which people, and how do you know?"
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

Grade 11 is the band anchor for high school. It is the year the work becomes recognizable to an adult founder: a 3-person team with a written charter; a recorded sales conversation scored on a 6-criterion rubric; a 12-month cash flow forecast that names the tight month; a 6-week sprint with five experiments and a panel-judged pitch. The previous year (Grade 10) gave students the structural and capital scaffolding — sole prop versus LLC, funding-source comparison, premortems. This year puts those scaffolds under live load.

The pedagogical bones come from three traditions:

- **Understanding by Design.** Big ideas, essential questions, and a year-end performance task drive planning. Lessons feed the Capstone, not the other way around.
- **Workshop model.** Mini-lesson (10–15 min) → guided work (30–45 min) → confer + close (10 min). At Grade 11 the work blocks are longer and the teacher conferring is more substantive.
- **Routines, not heroics.** A small set of weekly routines — Monday Cash + question, Wednesday work block, Friday demo + retro — protect the cognitive heavy lift for the content.

Classroom routines

These run all year. Establish them in the first three weeks and protect them.

Monday — Cash + the Question

A 5-minute Cash video (or printed transcript if no projector) introduces the week's question. Students respond to a one-prompt opener in the Capstone Journal. Whole-class share-out: 2–3 students.

Wednesday — Work Block

The longest block of the week, 60–90 minutes, dedicated to the Capstone. Mini-lesson (10–15) → team work (40–60) → 10-minute close. Teacher confers with each team for 5–8 minutes.

Friday — Demo + Retro

20-minute share. One team demos progress. The class runs a "Continue / Stop / Start / Decide" mini-retro on the demo using the Unit 1 frame.

Daily — the Vocabulary Spine

A single-page running glossary at the back of the notebook. Students add 1–3 terms per week with a Frayer entry for "weight-bearing" terms (marked with an asterisk in the year vocabulary list).

Pedagogy at this grade band

- **Treat them as junior colleagues.** Grade 11 students can take direct, honest feedback. Sugar-coating reads as not taking them seriously.
- **Concrete, then abstract.** Run the math on real (or carefully simulated) numbers before generalizing. Use real local prices.
- **Talk before write.** Most 16-year-olds know more than they can put on paper at first try. Pair-share before journal write.
- **Identity-aware.** Students at this age are figuring out who they are publicly. Let them choose Capstone categories that signal something true to them — but coach against ventures that exclude classmates.
- **Visible thinking.** The Vocabulary Spine, Capstone Journal, sprint board, and pinned-to-wall pitch deck make student thinking observable.
- **Less worksheet, more artifact.** A team charter, a 6-criterion sales rubric self-score, a 12-month forecast, and a 6-week sprint are the year's products. Worksheets serve practice; they're not the goal.

Assessment philosophy

> **“What would have to be true for you to be wrong?”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

Assess two things at every checkpoint:

1. **Did the team do the work the standard names?** Real role-plays, real forecasts, real sprints, real pitches. The recording exists. The spreadsheet computes. The panel was watching.
2. **Did the team think about it?** Each pack includes a "what we got wrong on the first try" memo. Reflection is a learning goal, not garnish.

Use the program's analytic rubrics from the Rubric Bank. Holistic scoring is allowed only for Cash-video reflections and weekly exit tickets.

A typical assessment cadence

Cadence	Form	Stakes
Daily	Exit ticket or work-block confer	Low — formative
Weekly	Capstone Journal entry + Friday demo	Low–medium — counts toward habit grade
Bi-weekly	Vocabulary check (10 terms)	Low — formative
End of unit	Capstone checkpoint with rubric	Medium-high — analytic rubric
End of year	6-week sprint + pitch	Highest — full-year synthesis

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

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Pacing — week by week

Adjust to your actual calendar (assume ~36 weeks). Each week needs roughly 120–180 instructional minutes for Cash to Company; the Capstone Journal homework is 10–15 minutes of writing.

Unit 1 — Leading without authority (Weeks 1–8)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
1	Course launch + Cash V1 ("Leadership without authority")	Day 1 Leadership Stance; Charisma vs. Clarity sort	Choose Capstone category
2	Pick the venture + form teams	Skills + needs reflection; team interest signal	Lock Capstone topic + tentative team
3	Lock teams + first charter draft	Charter mini-lesson; section drafting	Submit Charter v1
4	First 1:1 + sprint launch	Cash V2 ("The First 1:1"); 1:1 practice	Run 4-week sprint week 1
5	Sprint week 2 + dependency mapping	Dependency map; mid-sprint adjust	Sprint week 2 demo
6	Sprint week 3 + conflict coaching	Conflict-style awareness recycled from Grade 9	Sprint week 3 demo
7	Sprint week 4 + retrospective	Useful Retrospective lesson	Sprint week 4 demo
8	**Checkpoint 1** — Team Pack	Charter v2 + retro + 1:1 logs	Submit Team Pack (graded)

Unit 2 — Sales is structured listening (Weeks 9–18)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
9	Cash V3 ("Discovery Is More Than Half") + optional pivot window	Pivot decision (kept or new venture)	Confirm Capstone or pivot
10	Discovery question design	Discovery script (7 questions, 4 layers)	Submit discovery script
11	Bad-sales-call critique + 5-step structure	Critique exercise; structure mini-lesson	Map your 5 steps
12	Practice round 1 (easy customer)	Pair role-plays	Run role-play
13	Practice round 2 (harder customer) + Cash V4	Recording introduction	Record 1st draft
14	Recorded role-play + self-score	Sales rubric self-score	Submit recording
15	Objection-handling: 3 hard calls	Acknowledge-Clarify-Respond practice	Draft objection scripts
16	No-fit conversation + ESL no-go list	No-go list draft	Submit no-go list
17	Ethics anchor + peer-score calibration	Peer scoring of recordings	Peer-score 2 recordings
18	**Checkpoint 2** — Sales Pack	Final recording + memos	Submit Sales Pack (graded)

Unit 3 — The cash flow truth (Weeks 19–28)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
19	Cash V5 ("Profit Is an Opinion. Cash Is a Fact.") + optional pivot window	Profit vs. Cash sort	Confirm Capstone
20	BAVC field interview prep	Interview script for local business	Schedule interview
21	Field interview + 3-decisions analysis	Interview + writeup	Submit case study
22	Cash flow forecast (12-month)	We-do tutoring example + you-do	Build forecast v1
23	Tight month + 2 fixes	Tight-month analysis	Submit fixes
24	Sensitivity analysis + Cash V6	One-variable sensitivity	Submit sensitivity table
25	Break-point analysis	Walk down worst variable	Identify break point
26	Two-fix memo (1 page)	Memo writing mini-lesson	Draft memo
27	Peer review + revision	Critique frame	Revise memo
28	**Checkpoint 3** — Cash Pack	Forecast + memo + sensitivity	Submit Cash Pack (graded)

Unit 4 — Execute under uncertainty (Weeks 29–36)

Week	Focus	Anchor activities	Capstone milestone
29	Cash V7 ("The 5-Experiment Backlog") + optional pivot window	Hypothesis mini-lesson	Confirm Capstone
30	Build the growth backlog	5-experiment template + leading/lagging	Submit backlog
31	Sprint week 1	Sprint board setup; experiment 1 launches	Demo 1
32	Sprint week 2	Experiment 2 launches; experiment 1 read-out	Demo 2
33	Sprint week 3	Experiment 3 launches	Demo 3
34	Sprint week 4	Pivot/persevere check; experiment 4	Demo 4
35	Sprint week 5 + pitch deck draft	Cash V8 ("Pitch Day"); deck building	Pitch deck v1
36	**Final defense** — pitch to panel + revision	Panel Q&A revision plan	Final Sprint Pack

Common pitfalls (and the moves that fix them)

Pitfall 1: The team that skips the charter.

The team that says "we'll just figure it out" returns at Week 4 to fix what they didn't define at Week 3. **Move:** non-negotiable charter submission in Week 3. No work block until the charter is filed.

Pitfall 2: Discovery-skipping in sales.

Most students underdo discovery and overdo presenting. **Move:** in Lesson 4, time the role-plays and read out the discovery-to-present ratio. If discovery is under 50% of the conversation, redo.

Pitfall 3: The "we'll just hustle harder" experiment.

A team writes "we'll do more outreach" and calls it an experiment. It's a to-do, not an experiment. **Move:** require all 5 experiments to follow the If/Then/Because hypothesis structure. No hypothesis, no experiment.

Pitfall 4: Magical revenue assumptions.

A team forecasts $5,000/month in Month 2 with no evidence. **Move:** require the forecast to cite the assumption source ("based on 3 customer interviews from Unit 2" or "estimate, to test in Experiment 1"). Magical numbers without sources go back for revision.

Pitfall 5: The "we crushed it" pitch.

A team presents a hype-laden pitch with no learning slide. **Move:** the rubric gives a 4 only if "what we learned" is specific (named experiment that failed, named decision that didn't pan out). Hype is graded as 2 even if delivery is smooth.

Pitfall 6: Sales pressure into manipulation.

A student gets good at the moves and starts using them on classmates. **Move:** the "honest claim" criterion is non-negotiable. A great sale that involves a misleading claim scores 1 on that row. Make this explicit in Week 11 and refuse to soften it.

Pitfall 7: Team conflict that needs adult mediation.

A team will hit a real conflict around Week 5–6 of the sprint. **Move:** facilitate one mediated conversation using the charter's escalation path. Do not solve the conflict for them. Coach toward direct, kind, specific language.

FAQ

> **“I don't know either. That's why we test.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

Q. I'm not an entrepreneur. Can I teach this? A. Yes. The Cash videos do the cold-introducing of concepts. Your job is to enforce two norms: which people, and how do you know? and what's the honest claim? Your teaching is question-asking more than answer-giving.

Q. What if my school doesn't have spreadsheets / video / project tools? A. The 12-month forecast can be done on paper with a calculator (reduce to 6 months if needed). Sales role-

plays can be audio-only on a phone. The sprint board can be sticky notes on a wall. The curriculum is tool-agnostic.

Q. How do I recruit a panel for the final pitch? A. Start by Week 30. Aim for 3–5 adults: one local entrepreneur, one school staff member, one parent, optionally one bank/credit-union community-liaison person. Coach the panel before they arrive: questions that surface evidence, not gotchas.

Q. A student wants to launch a real venture mid-year. What do I do? A. Real launches are a family decision, not a curriculum requirement. The Capstone is fully educational. If a student wants to go real, point them to the Grade 12 program where the curriculum supports it. In Grade 11, support the venture as a Capstone but don't require legal/financial real-money steps.

Q. A student's family is struggling financially. How do I avoid harm? A. The curriculum norm: never ask about family money. Always frame examples as "for a hypothetical 16-year-old" or "for a sample venture." If a student volunteers their own situation, listen but don't probe. Pivot the activity to the case-study version.

Q. How do I grade teams fairly when one teammate did most of the work? A. The Reflection Writing Rubric and the 1:1 logs are individual. The Charter and the Pitch are team. Use the individual artifacts to differentiate grades within a team when needed, and use the Week 8 retro to surface the imbalance early. The charter's accountability section was supposed to prevent this — if it didn't, that's the lesson.

Q. What if a student really wants to switch teams mid-year? A. The pivot windows in Weeks 9, 19, and 29 allow venture changes, not team changes. Team-composition changes require teacher sign-off and are rare. Working with the same three people through difficulty is part of the curriculum's intent.

Q. The "honest claim" criterion feels harsh. Should I soften it? A. No. It's the year's ethics anchor. A great sale that involves a misleading claim scores 1 on that row no matter how smooth. Soften this and you've taken out the year's most important lesson.

Q. My class is bigger than ideal — 35 students, ~12 teams. How do I scale conferring? A. Confer with one team per work block, rotating across the week. Use peer-coaching pairs — a stronger team paired with a struggling team for 15-minute weekly check-ins. Friday demos give you a window into all teams at once.

Calibration norms (rubric scoring)

- Pull a 3 anchor paper before scoring; recalibrate to it.
- Read for evidence of the standard, not effort or neatness.
- Each criterion is scored independently.

- The "honest claim" and "what we learned" criteria are evidence-only — vague language earns a 2 even with strong delivery.
- Peer scoring (Unit 2 and Unit 4) requires a calibration discussion before students score each other.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 11

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

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What success looks like at the end of Grade 11

A successful Grade 11 student does not necessarily start a real business. A successful student:

- Led 3 people for 4 weeks and wrote a retrospective the team revisits.
- Recorded a sales conversation, scored it, and named one specific thing to change.
- Built a 12-month cash flow forecast and identified the tight month with two fixes.
- Ran a 6-week sprint with 5 named experiments and tracked metrics weekly.
- Delivered a pitch with a "what we learned" slide and incorporated panel feedback into a revision.
- Wrote a no-go list with three specific behaviors the venture refuses, even when they would work.

If a Grade 11 student can do those six things, the year worked. They are now ready for Grade 12, where the curriculum runs whatever they built here to a Launch-or-Learn decision.

A final word

> **“An MVP is the smallest test that could change your mind. It's not a v1.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 11

The teachers who run this year well share one move: they don't rescue. When a team is stuck at Week 5 of the sprint, they ask "what did your charter say to do?" When a student delivers a vague pitch, they ask "which people, and how do you know?" When a forecast is magical, they ask "what's your evidence for that revenue?" The students do the thinking. Cash asks the question. You hold the line.

That's the deal.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — Differentiation deep moves (Grade 11)

Advanced learners — three named extensions

1. **3-statement consistency check.** Build a P&L, cash flow, and balance-sheet sketch and confirm they agree. (At Grade 12, students are required to do this; advanced 11th-graders can preview.)
2. **Sensitivity to three variables.** Most students do one-variable sensitivity. Advanced learners do three: revenue, variable cost, fixed cost. Identify which moves outcome most.
3. **Investor Q&A simulation.** Advanced students record a 5-min pitch + 5 panel questions from teachers/peers playing skeptical investors. Self-score against the Pitch rubric.

ELL deep moves

- **Cash flow template with rows pre-labeled in two languages.**
- **Sales conversation script in two columns.** English + home language for first attempt.
- **Cognate-rich vocabulary.** Liderazgo, hipótesis, métrica, pivot.

IEP/504 deep moves

- **Pre-built cash flow spreadsheet.** Student enters numbers; spreadsheet computes ending cash month-by-month.
- **Sales role-play scripts pre-written for first attempt.** Improvise on second.
- **Sprint-board template (Trello/Asana visual).** Cards pre-printed; student moves them through Doing → Done.

Bring forward Grade 9's conflict-style work

Grade 9's conflict-handling-style lesson (avoid, accommodate, compete, compromise, collaborate) was the only place students self-assess as collaborators. At Grade 11, surface that work in Unit 1: "Two years ago you named a conflict style. Bring it forward. What do you do under stress, and what's the move you want to use this year?"

ROUND 2 PATCH — Cash Never Says (Teacher Reference Card)

Cash never says: "Amazing!" / "Crushing it!" / "Boss up" / "Get that bag" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Financial freedom" / "Just believe" / "Side

hustle" (use "side venture") / wealth-flexing language / anything implying wealth is mindset/ hustle / anything implying low-income or unbanked families are at fault.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "Whats the evidence?" / "What would have to be true for you to be right/wrong?"

Teacher mirror: Replace "great job!" with "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?"

Cashs three signature physical moves: (1) **Notebook Tilt**; (2) **Two-Finger Tap**; (3) **Slow Lean**.

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 11 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“Leading three people, listening to one customer, executing six weeks.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 11**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).